

CORE RESOLUTION

1d10 + Skill Base vs. Difficulty (DC)

Roll meets or beats the DC to succeed. A tie **fails**. If a character lacks a Skill Base, roll the die and add the governing Statistic instead (see Skills, p.2).

Opposed Checks: both sides roll; higher total wins. On a tie, the **defender** (the one reacting) succeeds; if neither side is reacting, it's a draw and the action must be repeated.

Percentile Rolls: roll 1d10 twice — first die = tens, second = ones. 0 & 0 = 100.

EXPLODING DICE

When a **10** is rolled on a Skill Check, add 10 to the total and roll again, adding that result too. Keep rolling and adding as long as 10s keep coming up.

When a **1** is rolled, roll again and *subtract* that result from the total. If the second roll is also a 10, subtract 10 and roll (and subtract) again. A Skill Check result can never drop below 1.

1s and 10s explode on Skill Checks only — not on damage or percentile rolls.

DIFFICULTY TABLE

DIFFICULTY	DC	EXAMPLE
Easy	10	Picking a simple lock
Average	14	Picking an average lock
Challenging	18	Picking a well-made lock
Difficult	20	Cracking a vault
Nearly Impossible	30	Cracking a masterwork vault

GM sets the DC directly (DC:X) or from this table when none is given.

MODIFIERS

LEVEL	VALUE
Mild	±1
Moderate	±3
Major	±5

Bonuses/penalties for circumstance (tools, lighting, distraction, terrain, position) are added before comparing to the DC. Multiple modifiers stack.

Multiple attackers: Mild (-1) to Defense per enemy beyond the first in melee range.

SAVE CHECKS

1d10 vs. Save Stat

Used whenever a character risks being stunned or killed. Roll **under** the Save value to succeed; equal or higher **fails** (stunned/dying, per effect).

LUCK points may be spent to raise a Save by 1 each, or add a Mild (+1) to any Skill Check.

STATISTICS

INT Intelligence	memory, perception, deduction
REF Reflexes	unarmed/melee combat, riding
DEX Dexterity	ranged combat, sleight of hand, stealth
BODY	strength, endurance
SPD Speed	movement per turn
EMP Empathy	social skills, performance
CRA Craft	making/using things, medicine
WILL	magic, intimidation, courage
LUCK	pool spent for +1 bonuses / +1 Save

DERIVED STATS

HP	lethal damage pool
STA Stamina	non-lethal damage pool & spell fuel
VIGOR	threshold of STA spendable per round on magic before it hurts you
SAVE	target for Save Checks
REC Recovery	HP/STA regained per rest period
LEAP	movement in difficult terrain / climbing / swimming

SKILL CHECK — WORKED EXAMPLE

Andras wows a crowd with lute playing: roll 1d10 → 6, + Performance Skill Base 14 = **20** total. If the DC was Average (14), that's a clean success.

No matching Skill Base? Roll 1d10 + the governing Statistic instead (e.g. no Performance → roll + EMP).

RACIAL & CLASS TRAITS

examples

Witcher	+1 Awareness; no penalty in dim light; no Courage Check vs. Intimidation but -4 EMP; +1 permanent REF & DEX (can exceed 10)
Human	+1 Deduction; Mild (+1) Charisma/Seduction/Persuasion vs. other humans; re-roll a failed Courage/Resist Coercion 3×/session
Dwarf	+1 Business; +1 Physique; reduce physical damage taken by 2 (after Armor, before location multiplier)
Elf	+1 Fine Arts; +2 Archery, draws/strings a bow free; beasts treat them as friendly

Every Profession also grants a unique **Defining Skill** — a special, class-specific ability rolled like a Skill Check (e.g. Witcher Training, Healing Hands, Busking, Practiced Paranoia).

SKILLS		governing Statistic in parens	
Alchemy	INT	Monster Lore	INT
Archery	DEX	Performance	EMP
Athletics	DEX	Persuasion	EMP
Awareness	INT	Pick Lock	CRA
Brawling	REF	Physique	BODY
Business	INT	Resist Coercion	WILL
Courage	WILL	Resist Magic	WILL
Crafting	CRA	Riding	REF
Crossbow	DEX	Seduction	EMP
Deceit	EMP	Sleight of Hand	DEX
Deduction	INT	Small Blades	REF
Disguise	CRA	Social Etiquette	INT
Dodge/Escape	REF	Spell Casting	WILL
Education	INT	Staff/Spear	REF
Endurance	BODY	Stealth	DEX
First Aid	CRA	Streetwise	INT
Gambling	EMP	Swordsmanship	REF
Human Perception	EMP	Tactics	INT
Intimidation	WILL	Wilderness Survival	INT
Melee	REF		

ROUNDS & INITIATIVE	
Initiative = 1d10 + REF	
A round represents ~3 seconds. Highest Initiative acts first; ties broken by higher REF. A character may voluntarily delay to act later, resetting their Initiative to that point.	
Monsters/NPCs act on Rate of Fire (ROF) instead of Fast/Strong Strikes — ROF is how many attacks they get on their Attack Action.	

ON YOUR TURN	
Each turn: Movement (up to SPD in meters) + one Action , in either order (movement cannot be split around the action).	
Attack	Fast or Strong Strike
Casting	Cast a Sign or Spell
Item	Draw, pick up, or use an item
Movement	Extra movement equal to SPD
Skill	Any Skill usable in ~3 seconds
Extra Action: spend 3 STA for one more Action; Skill Checks for it take a Moderate (-3) penalty. PCs only.	
Difficult terrain (climbing, swimming, squeezing through): move LEAP meters instead of SPD.	

ATTACK ACTIONS	
1d10 + Skill Base + WA	
Fast Melee	2 attacks (can split targets), normal damage
Strong Melee	1 attack, Moderate (-3) to hit, x2 damage
Fast Ranged	1 attack w/ bow or crossbow; 2 if dual-wielding thrown weapons
Strong Ranged	bow/thrown only (not crossbow), Moderate (-3) to hit, x2 damage
Weapon Accuracy (WA): add/subtract the weapon's WA on every attack with it.	
Called Shot: target a specific hit location directly, at a penalty based on that location (skips the Hit Location roll on a hit).	

DEFENSE ACTIONS	
One free Defense Action per round (first attack); each additional Defense costs 1 STA. Unwilling/unable to defend? Attacker just needs DC:10.	
Block	weapon (its Skill Base) / shield (Melee) / body (Brawling) — body part hit if it succeeds
Dodge	Dodge/Escape — move a few inches, avoid the hit
Reposition	Athletics — avoid <i>and</i> move up to LEAP meters away (not toward attacker)
Ranged/thrown attacks can only be Blocked with a shield.	

RANGE & AMBUSH	
Attacking beyond a ranged weapon's listed Range: Major (-5) penalty, up to double the listed Range (its hard max).	
Ambush: attackers roll Stealth vs. targets' Awareness. Against anyone who loses, one free Attack Action at Major (+5), before Initiative is rolled for the fight.	

COMBAT MODIFIER EXAMPLES	
Attacking from ambush	Major (+5)
Target dog-sized/smaller, light cover	Mild (-1)
Target's movement heavily restricted	Moderate (+3)
Dim light / half in cover	Moderate (-3)
Total darkness / near-full cover	Major (-5)

SAMPLE WEAPON STATS WA / DMG / Effect

WEAPON	WA	DMG	EFFECT
Punch / Kick	+0	1d6±	Non-Lethal
Dagger / Poniard	+0/+1	1d6– 2d6+2	Bleed chance
Silver Sword	+0	1d6+2	Silver (+3d6 vs. monsters)
Steel Sword	+0	4d6+4	Armor Piercing
Battle Axe	+0	5d6+4	—
Spear / Staff	+0	1d6– 3d6+4	Long Reach
Short Bow	+0	3d6+3	Range 100m
Crossbow	+1	4d6+2	Range 100m
Hand Crossbow	+1	2d6+2	Range 50m
Throwing Knife	+0	1d6	Range 24m

Damage code XdY[+Z]: roll X dice of Y sides, add Z. Figures above are representative examples, not a complete armory.

DAMAGE — STEP BY STEP

1. **Roll damage dice** (XdY[+Z]) and add the attacker's BODY Damage Modifier (melee/thrown only).
2. **Add Silver dice** vs. monsters, if the weapon is silver.
3. **Strong Strike**: double the running total.
4. **Subtract Armor SP** at the hit location. 0 or less → attack repelled, stop.
5. **Hit Location multiplier** (below) — apply once damage penetrates Armor; round down, min 1.
6. **Resistance/Susceptibility**: ×½ if the target resists the damage type, ×2 if vulnerable to it.
7. **Apply** the final total to HP (lethal) or STA (non-lethal).

BODY DAMAGE MODIFIER

BODY	MODIFIER
1–2	Moderate (-3)
3–4	Mild (-1)
5–6	None
7–8	Mild (+1)
9–10	Moderate (+3)
10+	Major (+5)

HIT LOCATION

Roll 1d10 after a successful hit (skip if a Called Shot).

ROLL	LOCATION	PENALTY*	×DMG
1	Head	Major (-5)	×3
2–7	Upper Body	Mild (-1)	×1
8–10	Lower Body	Moderate (-3)	×½

*Penalty applies only when using a Called Shot to target that location.

ARMOR & ITS DAMAGE

Each Armor piece has a **Stopping Power (SP)** per location (Head/Upper/Lower). Subtract SP from incoming damage before the Hit Location multiplier.

Every time a hit **penetrates** Armor at a location, that piece's SP drops by 1. At SP 0, it's broken and useless.

Damage types: **lethal** (HP) is default; unarmed strikes and some spells/creature abilities are **non-lethal** (STA).

CRITICAL WOUNDS

Attack Check beats the Defense Check by **10+** → Critical Wound: +5 bonus damage (ignores Armor) plus an ongoing effect by location.

LOC.	UNTREATED	TREATED
Head	-1 INT/WILL, Save Concussion	-1 WILL
Upper	-2 BODY, -1 REF Broken Ribs	-1 BODY/DEX
Lower	-3 SPD, Dodge & Athletics Injured Leg	-1 SPD, Dodge & Athletics

Treat: a Doctor spends 4 full rounds, DC:15 Healing Hands (or GM-approved First Aid). **Heal fully** after Body-based days: 1–4 BODY = 5 days, 5 = 3, 6–7 = 2, 8+ = 1 day.

STABILIZATION

0 STA → **Unconscious**. 0 HP → **Dying** (Save Check now, and again each round or when hit again, cumulative Mild (-1) each time).

First Aid Check stabilizes: DC:10 (Unconscious) / DC:15 (Dying). Success ends the condition and sets HP/STA to 1.

HEALING

STA: regain REC per hour rested (halved if any of that hour is strenuous).

HP: requires a DC:10 First Aid Check to begin treatment, then regain REC per day rested (halved by strenuous activity; +3/day if a Doctor uses Healing Hands instead of First Aid).

CASTING SIGNS & SPELLS

1d10 + Spell Casting Skill Base vs. target number

Cast as an Action or Extra Action (multiple casts/round possible). Beat the target number to succeed — the spell/Sign's listed effect occurs; otherwise it fails (but STA is still spent).

Fumble: rolling a 1 on the casting roll fails *and* harms the caster — see Fumble Table.

TARGET NUMBERS BY TYPE	
Direct	hits a specific target adversely; Direct (Physical) can be Defended against normally, others use the noted Skill Check
Area	fills a cone/radius; anyone inside when cast (or who enters) is checked; Area (Physical) uses any Defense Action
Defense: None	cannot be defended against at all — success just requires not rolling a 1

STAMINA & VIGOR THRESHOLD

Every spell/Sign has a **Stamina Cost**, paid from STA when cast. A witcher's **Sign** STA cost is variable (1–7, caster's choice) — higher cost = stronger effect. Mage spells have a fixed cost.

Vigor Threshold: if total STA spent on casting in one round exceeds it, the caster takes **5 HP damage per point over** the threshold — ignores Armor.

Active duration spells cost STA again each round to maintain (counts toward Vigor Threshold), but can be dropped anytime for free.

QUICK REMINDERS

- 0 on a d10 = 10, not zero.
- Effects of the same type don't stack — reapplying refreshes, it doesn't add.
- Long Reach weapons hit targets 2m away in melee.
- Armor-Piercing damage ignores resistances (except a monster's non-silver resistance).
- Falling: 1d6 lethal dmg to upper body per 2m fallen.

RANGE & DURATION

A spell/Sign cannot affect anything beyond its listed Range. **Immediate** duration resolves instantly; random durations (e.g. 1d10 rounds) are rolled and end at the end of the caster's turn on the final round.

FUMBLE TABLE	roll d10 on a casting 1
1–6	HP damage = Stamina Cost of the spell, ignores Armor
7–9	Above, +element mishap: Earth=stunned, Air=knocked prone/back 2m, Fire=set aflame, Water=frozen, Mixed=roll 1d6 (1 Earth / 2 Air / 3–5 Fire / 6 Water)
10	Above, + 2m-radius blast: HP damage = Stamina Cost to everyone nearby (upper body, Armor applies)

WITCHER SIGNS		STA cost 1–7, scales effect
Aard (Air)	2m cone, staggers; knockdown chance +10%/STA	
Axii (Water)	8m, stuns until a Save (Mild -1 penalty per 2 extra STA)	
Igni (Fire)	2m cone, 1d6 dmg/STA to upper body, 50% ignite	
Quen (Earth)	shield, 5 HP per STA spent, absorbs damage before you	
Yrden (Mixed)	3m circle, 5 rounds; SPD/REF penalty = STA spent; forces incorporeal creatures corporeal	

CRAFTING & ALCHEMY — PROCESS

1. **Diagram/Formula:** must be known/owned — lists ingredients, time, and DC.
2. **Components:** gather/buy every listed ingredient (consumed whether the attempt succeeds or fails).
3. **The Check:** roll Alchemy (potions/oils/bombs) or Crafting (weapons/armor/items) vs. the formula's DC, taking the listed time. Success = item made; failure = components wasted, try again with fresh components.

EFFECTS	
Bleed	2 HP/turn until First Aid DC:15
Blinded	Moderate (-3) Atk/Def, Major (-5) Awareness
Dying	see Stabilization, p.3
Fire	5 dmg/turn (Head/Upper/Lower), burns 1 SP/turn; douse to end
Freeze	Moderate (-3) SPD, Mild (-1) REF; DC:16 Physique to break
Poison	3 lethal dmg/turn, ignores Armor; ends via DC:15 First Aid or Endurance
Prone	Moderate (-3) Atk/Def; stand via Movement or help
Stun	no move/Action/Defense; ends via Save (full turn) or being hit
Unconscious	prone, no actions; ends via Stabilizing
% chance effects: roll percentile — result ≤ the stated chance inflicts it.	